Scott Clark

Palo Alto, CA
scott@scottclark.io
www.scottclark.io
github.com/sc932
linkedin.com/in/sc932

- Serial YC-and-a16z-backed exited founder, F100 executive, and published AI researcher
- Built and led teams from 2 to 200, responsible for everything from novel research to $70M+ P&L
- 5 STEM degrees; Cornell Applied Math PhD (DOE Computational Science Graduate Fellow); 15 peer-reviewed papers, 20 granted patents, 1,200+ citations (h-index 16); Forbes 30 Under 30

Experience

- **Distributional** — Palo Alto, CA
  Co-founder and CEO — *July 2023 - current*
  - Analytics for agents, discovering behavioral signals in AI logs for continuous improvement
  - Built enterprise tooling for AI reliability with statistical testing and adaptive analytics
  - Led a remote team of 30. Raised $30M from a16z, Two Sigma, others over 2 rounds

- **Intel** — Portland, OR
  VP & GM of AI and HPC in Supercomputing Group — *November 2020 - June 2023*
  - Led a team of 200 engineers and technologists worldwide, overseeing a $70M annual budget
  - Responsible for AI and HPC application quality on 35MW+ government datacenters
  - Promoted from Director to Sr. Director to VP, supporting multiple chip and datacenter launches

- **SigOpt** — San Francisco, CA
  Co-founder and CEO — *November 2014 - November 2020*
  - Bayesian Optimization-as-a-Service product based on my PhD and open source work
  - Led a team of 25; published research at top conferences and closed several million in ARR
  - Acquired by Intel. Raised $17M from a16z, Two Sigma, YC (W15), others over 3 rounds

- **Yelp** — San Francisco, CA
  Data Mining Engineer and Lead on Ad Targeting Team — *July 2012 - December 2014*
  - Led MOE team (Metric Optimization Engine), 1.3k+ star open source repo based on my PhD
  - Developed novel location-based and bandit-optimized ad targeting algorithms
  - Created the Yelp Dataset Challenge, used by hundreds of thousands of students globally

Education and Research Experience

- **Cornell University** — Ithaca, NY
  Ph.D. Applied Mathematics, M.S. Computer Science — *2008 - 2012*
  - Department of Energy Computational Science Graduate Fellow (Full Scholarship, 4 years)
  - AI, ML, and Computational Science applied to bioinformatics and global optimization

- **Oregon State University** — Corvallis, OR
  B.Sc. Mathematics, B.Sc. Computational Physics, B.Sc. Physics — *2004 - 2008*
  - Graduated Magna Cum Laude with three Bachelors of Science degrees in four years

- **Summer Research** Worldwide
  Internships and DOE/NSF Research Assistant Roles *2006-2011*
  - 2011: Bloomberg LP - Forward and backward portfolio analysis
  - 2010: DOE Joint Genome Institute - Metagenomic assembly analysis and evals
  - 2009: Los Alamos National Laboratory - Sequence alignment research using CUDA
  - 2008: Oregon State University - Finite element analysis with uncertainty
  - 2007: Max Planck Institute (PKS, Dresden) - Research on quantum extreme value statistics
  - 2006: University of California: Davis - Computational biophysics analysis of protein folding

Expertise

- **Executive:** P&L; org design from 2 to 200; M&A sell-side (SigOpt→Intel 2020); ∼$47M raised over 5+ rounds; board governance (chairman of SigOpt and Distributional boards, OMSI Treasurer, OSU CoS).
- **Research:** Bayesian optimization, AutoML, ML/AI/LLM-Ops, LLM/agent evaluation, AI reliability and testing; 15 peer-reviewed papers, 20 patents (h-index 16, 1,200+ cites on Google Scholar).
- **Technical:** Python; production-ML observability; statistical testing for AI; experiment design; HPC at DOE-supercomputer scale (NERSC PI).
- **Communication:** 40+ keynotes/conferences (NVIDIA GTC, MLconf, SC22, O'Reilly AI, Ai4); 20+ podcast appearances; several hundred executive briefings to F500 execs and boards over 10+ years via the a16z executive briefing center.

Board & Civic Service

- **Oregon Museum of Science and Industry (OMSI)** Portland, OR
  Trustee *2022-2025*
  - Treasurer; Executive Committee; Chair, Finance Committee
- **Oregon State University College of Science** Corvallis, OR
  Board Member *2019-2025*
  - Board of Advisors, Industry and Innovation Council